

September 11 - Childhood, Adolescent and Young Adult Cancer Data Innovation Challenge Webinar

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News from NCI's Office of Data Sharing

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August 2026

Events

**Childhood, Adolescent and Young Adult Cancer Data Innovation Challenge:
Harnessing Data and Technology. Accelerating Discovery. Improving Outcomes.**

[Registration.](#)

Date and Time: September 11, 2026, 1:30 PM – 2:30 PM EDT

Speakers: Emily Boja, Branch Chief, NCI Office of Data Sharing.

Join the National Cancer Institute (NCI) Office of Data Sharing (ODS) for a pre-submission webinar introducing a new prize competition: the [Childhood, Adolescent and Young Adult Cancer Data Innovation Challenge Phase I](#) (\$17,000,000 total cash prize). Learn about the competition's goals, eligibility requirements, submission process, key deadlines. The session will conclude with a live Q&A to address participant questions.

Childhood Cancer Data Initiative Symposium

Join the [Childhood Cancer Data Initiative \(CCDI\)](#) Symposium on September 18, 2026, to reflect on our progress and shape what comes next in childhood cancer research. At this hybrid event, offered both in person at the National Cancer Institute (NCI) Shady Grove Campus in Rockville, MD and online, we will highlight the foundational work accomplished by CCDI so far and work together with members across the cancer research community to explore opportunities to accelerate discovery and improve outcomes for children, adolescents, and young adults through an interoperable data ecosystem and innovative use of AI.

CCDI Virtual Workshops

NCI will also be holding three virtual workshops over the summer to collect feedback and input from the community on topics critical to the priorities of CCDI.

**Patient Permissioning and Authorities Needed to Connect the CCDI Ecosystem
Across Networks and Platforms**

Monday, August 24, 2026, 10:00 a.m. - 11:30 a.m.

We invite all members of the community to attend – [register today!](#)

NCI ODS Fourth Annual Data Sharing Symposium

Join NCI and cancer research colleagues as we gather for the [Fourth Annual Data Sharing Symposium](#), a free hybrid event!

On November 5th and 6th, the NCI Office of Data Sharing (ODS) is hosting the Annual Data Sharing Symposium *Data to Discovery: Leveraging Cancer Data in the “Real World.”* This event will focus on the advancement of cancer research by leveraging real world cancer data through sharing and reuse. [Register here.](#)

Attendees are invited to present a poster describing how data sharing has impacted your cancer research, or to set up a table to demo an innovative data sharing product. For submission and additional details see the [abstract submission](#), **deadline Tuesday, September 1, 2026.**

- Posters that showcase novel, impactful, or other meaningful efforts to increasing FAIR sharing of cancer research data are welcome
- Groups who would like to showcase innovative cancer-relevant data sharing capabilities or strategies are welcome to apply for a table setup

[Email the Office of Data Sharing](#) if you would like more information or have general questions.

Data Sharing Champion: NCI-Funded Big Data Training for Cancer Research Program at UCI



Cancer research today generates staggering volumes of data—genomic, transcriptomic, proteomic, and clinical information that, when properly harnessed, can accelerate the path to precision medicine. The Chao Family Comprehensive Cancer Center at UC Irvine addresses this need through the BigCARE, an NCI-funded "Big Data Training for Cancer Research" program. Established in 2020 and led by UCI professor Dr. Min Zhang, the program has spent six years cross-training cancer researchers to apply big data methods in ways that generate measurable scientific impact.

Open to oncology clinicians, faculty, postdoctoral researchers, and graduate students alike, BigCARE offers something increasingly rare in specialized scientific training: zero cost and true hands-on experience. Tuition and on-campus housing are both provided, removing financial barriers that often keep early-career researchers from advanced computational training with readily available datasets and data analytics tools.

Central to BigCARE's mission is a commitment to open science. Its 2026 workshop brought an intensive two-week session from July 20 to August 1 to the UCI campus that attracted over 100 applications and successfully onboarded 30 workshop participants. This year's lecture series featured Emily Boja, PhD, Branch Chief and Supervisory Health Scientist Administrator at the NCI Office of Data Sharing, who delivered a special in-person talk on "Sharing Data In the Digital Age: Why, What and How." Her presence underscores the workshop's core philosophy—that cancer breakthroughs depend not just on generating data, but on sharing it responsibly across institutions.

By equipping the next generation of cancer researchers with both technical fluency and a data-sharing mindset, BigCARE is helping build a research ecosystem where knowledge moves as fast as the data itself—turning raw information into real progress against cancer.

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